salesmsg | Blackberry Estates

CUSTOMER STORY

How Blackberry Estates booked $1.5M in weddings before they ever opened

How a 2-person team used automated SMS to outpace every competitor on speed.

RESULTS

~$1.5M	70+	First event	20
in booked wedding revenue in 9 months	weddings booked through 2026-2027	July 2026 calendar filled before opening	virtual tours per week at peak volume

Blackberry Estates, a luxury wedding venue in Asheville, NC, partnered with Johnson Jones Group and Salesmessage to generate ~$1.5M in booked revenue and 70+ weddings in just 9 months, before hosting a single event.

Business challenge

- Two founders handling all inbound volume, with no room for slow follow-up.
- Wedding leads evaluate multiple venues at once and go with whoever responds first.
- Voicemail and email were too slow to capture intent before it moved on.
- Needed to qualify leads before committing time to virtual tours.
- Growth was capped by headcount without automation in place.

Why Salesmessage + Johnson Jones Group

1. Automated SMS follow-up triggered within hours of every lead form.
2. Two-way texting let Nathan and Amanda respond from anywhere, immediately.
3. Text-first communication matched how couples prefer to be reached.
4. Simple, fast lead qualification before committing time to a tour.
5. Ongoing conversation management from first contact through booking close.

Implementation and usage

- Leads enter via Google Ads, then submit a form on the website.
- Automated email sends the pricing brochure within about 30 minutes.
- Salesmessage triggers an automated text 30 minutes to 2 hours after the email.
- Interested leads move into a two-way conversation and book a virtual tour.
- Salesmessage manages follow-up, scheduling and communication through close.

"We're consistently hearing from couples that we are the fastest and most responsive venue they've reached out to. That's not an accident. It's our system."

Nathan Bruce-Black
Co-Owner, Blackberry Estates

Conclusion

Two founders. A venue that hadn't opened yet. $1.5M booked before the first guest arrived. Speed became their greatest competitive advantage.